

Use Case Definition — AI Career LaunchPad

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Project: AI Career LaunchPad

Builder: Marco Martins

Context: Ironhack AI Consulting & Integration Bootcamp — Final Capstone Project

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1. Business Problem Statement

Professionals completing AI bootcamps arrive at the end of their programme with technical skills but without a credible positioning strategy. The typical candidate has 10–25 years of prior domain experience — in engineering, finance, healthcare, operations, or L&D — that represents genuine and rare consulting value. They do not know how to articulate it.

Existing career tools treat prior experience as a keyword list. They do not understand career transitions, working style, or how to reframe domain expertise as an AI consulting differentiator. The result is a predictable set of failure modes: generic applications, wrong role targeting, and systematic mispricing — candidates accepting junior or mid-level offers because they cannot make the seniority case for their background.

This is not a failure of the candidate. It is a structural gap in the transition support infrastructure. Technical training programmes, including high-quality ones, teach AI skills. They do not teach professionals how to translate 20 years of safety-critical engineering, or global learning platform management, or regulated-industry compliance work, into a forward-facing AI consulting identity.

AI Career LaunchPad addresses this gap directly. It takes what a candidate already knows — their LinkedIn history, their CliftonStrengths profile, and their own self-reflection — and produces a structured, personalised Career Compass that tells them who they are in the AI consulting market, which archetypes fit them, and exactly what to do next.

2. Company Profile

Field	Detail
Product name	AI Career LaunchPad
Builder / founder	Marco Martins
Stage	Pre-revenue, pre-company. Working POC with one live user.
Industry	Career services / EdTech / AI consulting enablement

Field	Detail
Company size	Solo builder
Operational state	Two workflows operational end to end (WF1 Career Compass, WF3 Application Engine). Hosted on n8n Cloud. No frontend. No auth layer. No payment infrastructure.
Commercialisation path	Dual-track: B2B (bootcamp operators as a structured complement to existing career services) and B2C (integrated into a career transition coaching practice, with a future licensing model for other coaches).

Important positioning note: AI Career LaunchPad is designed as a complement to existing career services — not a replacement. In the Ironhack context, it sits alongside CareerHack, addressing the AI-specific positioning gap that general career programmes do not cover. It does not compete with CV review, job board access, or recruiter networks. It solves the upstream problem: who am I in this market and how do I talk about it?

3. Proposed AI Solution

What the AI is doing

AI Career LaunchPad is a multi-stage generative AI pipeline built in n8n. It takes three unstructured PDF inputs (LinkedIn profile, CliftonStrengths report, Self-Reflection Workbook) and produces two structured outputs:

Output 1 — Career Compass Report (WF1) A personalised career positioning document covering: profile match against 8 AI consulting archetypes, positioning statement, elevator pitch, SWOT analysis, gap analysis with how-to-talk-about-it guidance, Clifton Strengths deployment guide, transition strategy scenarios, and a 90-day next steps plan with certifications and learning recommendations.

Output 2 — Application Engine Report (WF3) A job-specific application package covering: job fit score across four dimensions, gap analysis, Clifton deployment recommendations for the specific role, a tailored cover letter (maximum 350 words, first person, four structured paragraphs), and seven interview questions with Clifton-grounded answer guidance.

Type of AI system

The system combines four AI capabilities:

Structured extraction from unstructured documents. LLM nodes extract schema-constrained JSON from free-form PDF text. Extraction is factual — the system does not infer or invent beyond what the candidate has written.

Multi-dimensional scoring and matching (RAG-adjacent). A knowledge base of 8 career archetypes is loaded at runtime. The candidate portrait is scored against all 8 profiles across 4 dimensions. Hard constraint rules are applied programmatically to cap profiles that conflict with the candidate's stated hard avoids, ensuring scoring integrity independent of LLM arithmetic drift.

Personalised long-form generation. Sequential LLM nodes generate report content that is explicitly grounded in the candidate's actual data. Prompts enforce that every claim references a specific field from the candidate portrait. Banned-word lists and cardinality rules on arrays are enforced at prompt level.

Context-aware application generation. WF3 combines the full Career Compass output with a specific job description to generate a fit score, cover letter, and interview preparation grounded in the intersection of the two.

4. Key Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	Relationship to system
Career transition professional (individual)	Primary user	Submits their own LinkedIn, CliftonStrengths report, and self-reflection. Receives and acts on Career Compass and Application Engine outputs.
Marco Martins	Builder and first user	Designed and built the system. Using it during his own post-bootcamp job search.
Ironhack bootcamp participants	Beta test cohort	First external users. Shared context, shared transition challenge.
Bootcamp operators (B2B)	Licensing customer	Licence LaunchPad as a structured complement to their career services offering. Value: graduates who can articulate their positioning land better roles, which improves operator NPS and placement metrics.
Career transition coaches (B2C licensing)	Secondary licensing customer	Integrate LaunchPad into their coaching practice. Value: structured, AI-generated positioning analysis delivered before the coaching conversation, raising the quality of every session.
OpenAI	Technical dependency	Provides the LLM layer (gpt-4o, gpt-4o-mini). All candidate data passes through the OpenAI API. Relevant for GDPR and data governance (see gdpr_documentation.md).
n8n	Technical dependency	Workflow automation platform. Hosts the pipeline, triggers, code nodes, and webhook outputs.

5. Success Criteria

Criterion 1 — Bootcamp operator adoption (B2B traction)

Target: 4 bootcamp operators licensed within 18 months of commercial launch, each running a minimum of 4 cohorts per year at 15–20 participants per cohort.

Measurement: Signed licence agreements. Active deployments (form submissions per cohort). Revenue generated (target: €50–100 per participant per cohort).

Why this matters: Operator adoption validates that LaunchPad solves a real and recurring need — not a one-time use case. It also creates a repeatable distribution channel without a direct sales team.

Indicative revenue at target: 4 operators × 4 cohorts × 17.5 participants (midpoint) × €75 (midpoint) = €84,000 annually.

Criterion 2 — Individual user satisfaction with Career Compass output quality

Target: ≥ 80% of individual users who complete WF1 rate the Career Compass output as "accurate and useful" on a post-report feedback prompt (4 or 5 out of 5).

Measurement: Embedded single-question satisfaction prompt in the Career Compass HTML output. Responses logged to a lightweight backend (Supabase or Airtable).

Sub-criterion — profile match accuracy: ≥ 75% of users confirm that the top-ranked profile match "accurately reflects the type of AI consulting role I should be targeting."

Why this matters: The career positioning output is the core value proposition. If users do not recognise themselves in the report, the downstream application outputs (cover letter, interview prep) lose their grounding. Satisfaction at this stage is the leading indicator of everything else.

Criterion 3 — Time-to-first-interview (pilot measurement)

Target: Users who complete WF1 and WF3 and apply using the generated cover letter report a time-to-first-interview that is at least 20% shorter than the cohort average for non-users.

Measurement: Self-reported in a 30-day follow-up survey sent to all users. Cohort average collected from bootcamp operator career services data where available. Where not available, this criterion is measured as a directional signal rather than a hard metric.

Note: This criterion is harder to measure cleanly in a POC context and is treated as a pilot KPI to be validated in the MVP phase rather than a POC success gate.

6. Out-of-Scope Boundaries

The following are explicitly outside the scope of AI Career LaunchPad at POC and MVP stage:

Job search automation. LaunchPad does not search for jobs, scrape job boards, or submit applications on behalf of users. WF2 (Job Search Engine) is on the roadmap but is not part of the POC. Users source their own job descriptions and upload them manually to WF3.

CV or LinkedIn profile editing. LaunchPad reads and analyses the LinkedIn PDF. It does not rewrite it, suggest edits to it, or produce a reformatted CV. Positioning output is separate from profile editing.

Salary negotiation guidance. LaunchPad surfaces salary ranges associated with each career archetype as reference data. It does not advise on negotiation strategy or make recommendations about specific offers.

Psychometric assessment. LaunchPad uses CliftonStrengths as an input. It does not administer assessments, generate strengths reports, or substitute for the full CliftonStrengths assessment process. Users must have a completed Gallup CliftonStrengths report before using the system.

Recruiter or employer matching. LaunchPad produces application materials for the candidate. It does not connect candidates to recruiters, share profiles with employers, or operate as a job board or marketplace.

Coaching or counselling. LaunchPad generates structured advisory output grounded in the candidate's own data. It is not a substitute for human career coaching. In the B2C model, it is designed to complement and elevate coaching conversations — not replace them.

Languages other than English. All LLM prompts, output templates, and report structures are in English. Non-English LinkedIn profiles or CliftonStrengths reports will produce degraded output quality.
